

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management

Investment Memorandum: Morecambe Bay–Furness Tidal Gateway Infrastructure Fund

A Sovereign Wealth Fund-Style Investment Proposal for a Fleetwood–Barrow Integrated Tidal Barrage, Energy & Transport Corridor

Prepared for:

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A Manx Sovereign Infrastructure & Strategic Assets Manager

Investment Theme:

Energy Sovereignty | Northern Economic Renaissance | Intergenerational Infrastructure Assets

Executive Summary

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management proposes the creation of a **Manx Sovereign Infrastructure Fund** to acquire, finance and manage strategic ownership stakes in transformational UK infrastructure assets.

The flagship investment opportunity is:

The Morecambe Bay–Furness Tidal Gateway

A multi-purpose tidal barrage incorporating:

- Renewable tidal electricity generation
- High-capacity road connection
- Integrated rail corridor
- Coastal flood protection
- Industrial regeneration platform
- Tourism and logistics transformation

The project would create a permanent physical connection between:

Fleetwood / Fylde Peninsula

Morecambe Bay Energy Gateway

Barrow-in-Furness / Furness Peninsula

The investment thesis is that the project is not simply an energy asset, but a **regional productivity engine**, unlocking decades of economic growth by reducing geographical isolation between Lancashire and Cumbria.

Existing proposals for Morecambe Bay tidal infrastructure have identified the strategic opportunity of combining tidal generation with transport infrastructure. Previous concepts have included approximately 132 turbines, multi-billion-pound investment and a road connection across the bay.

1. Investment Thesis

"Turn geography from a constraint into an asset"

Northern England possesses:

- World-class industrial capability
- Significant renewable resources
- Large urban populations
- Major universities
- Deep-water ports
- Defence industries

However, western Lancashire and south Cumbria suffer from a historic infrastructure weakness:

The lack of a direct east-west coastal connection.

Today:

Fleetwood → Barrow

requires a long route around Morecambe Bay.

The barrage transforms this:

Before

Fleetwood → Barrow

- Long-distance road journey
- Limited labour mobility
- Weak supply-chain integration
- Peripheral economic status

After

Fleetwood ↔ Barrow

- Direct road corridor
 - Strategic rail link
 - Shared labour market
 - Integrated industrial region
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2. Strategic Asset Description

The Morecambe Bay Tidal Gateway

Core Infrastructure

A. Tidal Barrage

Indicative specification:

Asset	Specification
Location	Morecambe Bay
Length	~15km primary barrage
Technology	Tidal range hydro turbines
Turbines	~100–130 units
Operational life	100+ years
Generation	Several TWh annually

Previous feasibility work has identified the very high tidal range of Morecambe Bay as suitable for large-scale tidal generation, with estimates of around 7.8 TWh/year from wider northern tidal gateway concepts.

B. Renewable Electricity Generation

The barrage becomes:

"Britain's Lunar Power Station"

Unlike wind and solar:

- Tides are predictable
- Generation follows astronomical cycles
- Long asset lifespan
- Low operating costs after construction

Potential revenue:

Electricity Sales

Assumption:

5–8 TWh/year generation

At:

£80/MWh average power price

Potential gross energy revenue:

£400m–£640m annually

C. Strategic Transport Link

The barrage carries:

Road

A new high-capacity route:

Fleetwood

→

Lancashire coast

→

Barrow

Benefits:

- Reduced travel distance
- Reduced congestion
- Increased employment catchment

Existing tidal gateway concepts have suggested substantial reductions in travel distance and journey times between Lancashire and Furness.

Rail

EVWM proposes an enhanced vision:

Furness–Fylde Coastal Railway

A modern electrified railway:

Fleetwood

- Poulton-le-Fylde
- Morecambe Bay Gateway
- Barrow-in-Furness

Connecting:

- Barrow shipbuilding
- Lancaster universities
- Lancashire population centres
- Tourism economies

The rail component creates a:

3. Economic Impact Model

Regional GDP Transformation

The project creates a unified economic zone:

Current separated economies:

Lancashire Coast

- Tourism
- Manufacturing
- Services

Furness

- Defence
- Engineering
- Shipbuilding
- Energy

Combined:

The Morecambe–Furness Economic Region

Productivity Effects

Labour Market Expansion

A worker in:

Blackpool/Fleetwood

could access:

- Barrow engineering jobs
- Defence supply chains
- Advanced manufacturing

A worker in:

Barrow

could access:

- Lancashire services

- Universities
 - Housing markets
-

Estimated Economic Uplift

Illustrative model:

Regional GDP affected:

£25bn+

Productivity improvement:

2–5%

Potential additional economic output:

£500m–£1.25bn annually

4. Investment Structure

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management Infrastructure Fund I

Target Size:

£12 billion

Capital Structure

Investor	Contribution
Manx Sovereign Fund	£2bn
Pension funds	£4bn
Infrastructure investors	£3bn
UK institutional capital	£2bn
Strategic partners	£1bn

Ownership Model

EVWM does not act as contractor.

It becomes:

Long-Term Asset Owner

Similar to:

- Sovereign wealth funds
 - Infrastructure pension investors
 - National investment corporations
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5. Revenue Streams

1. Electricity

Estimated:

£400m–£640m/year

2. Transport Revenues

Road user charges:

£50m–£100m/year

3. Rail Operations

Passenger and freight:

£50m–£150m/year

4. Industrial Development

Create:

Tidal Enterprise Zone

Including:

- Green hydrogen
- Data centres
- Advanced manufacturing
- Shipbuilding supply chain
- Battery production

Potential land value uplift:

£1bn+

5. Carbon Credits

Potential:

- Renewable energy certificates
 - Carbon reduction credits
 - Nature restoration credits
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6. Investment Returns

Base Case

Project cost:

£10–15bn

Annual operating income:

£700m–£1bn

Asset life:

100 years+

Potential:

Infrastructure IRR

6–9%

Sovereign Wealth Return

8–12%+

The attraction:

A pension-style asset generating:

- Stable cashflows
 - Inflation-linked revenues
 - Strategic scarcity value
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7. Why Isle of Man?

Ellan Vannin Advantage

The Isle of Man has historic expertise in:

- Financial services
- Trust structures
- International capital
- Long-term investment

EVWM becomes:

"The Celtic-Northern Infrastructure Capital House"

The Manx model:

Not a speculative fund.

A:

100-year infrastructure ownership institution

Portfolio:

Energy

- Tidal
- Offshore wind
- Hydrogen

Transport

- Rail
- Ports
- Logistics

Digital

- Data centres
- AI infrastructure

Natural Assets

- Forestry
- Carbon

- Water
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8. Strategic Importance

This investment achieves:

Energy Security

A predictable renewable energy source.

Industrial Renewal

Supports:

- Barrow shipbuilding
- Lancashire manufacturing

Regional Equality

Connects communities historically separated by geography.

National Resilience

Creates privately financed strategic infrastructure.

9. Investment Recommendation

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management should establish:

The Ellan Vannin Northern Infrastructure Fund

with the Morecambe Bay–Furness Tidal Gateway as its anchor investment.

The project represents a rare category of asset:

Infrastructure that simultaneously produces energy, reduces transport costs, increases productivity, and creates regional wealth.

The investment case is therefore not:

"Can a barrage generate electricity?"

The investment case is:

"Can a 100-year asset transform the economic geography of Northern Britain?"

The answer is potentially yes.

Proposed Fund Name

EVWM — The Manx Northern Renaissance Fund

Investment Horizon: 100 years

Asset Class: Sovereign Infrastructure

Target Investors: Pension Funds, Family Offices, Sovereign Funds

Flagship Asset: Morecambe Bay Tidal Gateway